# Soobin Cho

✉ soobin30@uw.edu
5oobin.github.io/website

## Focus Areas

- Computer-Supported Cooperative Work
- Computer-Mediated Communication
- AI-Mediated Communication and Collaboration

## Education

**University of Washington** — Seattle, WA, USA
Ph.D. in Human Centered Design & Engineering (HCI) — Sep 2023 - 2028 (expected)
Advisors: Prof. David McDonald and Prof. Mark Zachry

**Seoul National University** — Seoul, South Korea
M.S. in Engineering, Intelligence & Information (HCI) — Sep 2019 - Feb 2022
Advisor: Prof. Joongseek Lee
**Thesis:** *Study on Remote Studying Activity with Video Conferencing Tool to Feel the Presence of Others: Focusing on Revealing and Hiding Themselves through Videos*

**Ewha Womans University** — Seoul, South Korea
B.A. in Communication & Media — Mar 2013 - Feb 2019
B.A. in International Studies (conc. in Business and Economics)

## Research Projects

**Investigating LLM-Assisted Participant Profiles for Sensemaking in Wikipedia Discussions**, Lead Researcher — ongoing

**Investigating LLM-Assisted Community Norm Guidance for Sensemaking in Wikipedia Discussions**, Lead Researcher — ongoing

**Examining Students' Use of LLMs for Interpersonal Communication in Academic Settings [P5, N5]**, Principal Investigator — ongoing

**Exploring LLM-Assisted Information Restructuring for Sensemaking in Wikipedia Discussions [under review, N6]**, Lead Researcher — 2026

**Understanding How LLMs Impact Participation in Knowledge Communities with a Focus on Wikipedia [R4]**, Research Assistant — 2025

**Applying Existing Design Recommendations to AI Companion Design [R5]**, Lead Researcher — 2025

**Exploring Short-Lived AI Companion Chatbots through Collaborative Autoethnography [P4]**, Lead Researcher — 2024

**Examining Wikipedian Views on Key Elements for LLM-Generated Discussion Summaries [R3]**, Lead Researcher — 2024

**Designing to Protect Privacy and Reduce Fear for Teens on Social Media [R2]**, Research Assistant — 2024

**Designing a Video Conferencing Interface for Virtual Co-Studying [P3]**, Lead Researcher — 2022

**Understanding Virtual Co-Studying Practices via Video Conferencing [R1]**, Lead Researcher — 2022

**Designing a Knowledge-Sharing Chatbot for Residents of Single-Person Housing [P2, N2]**, Lead Researcher 2021

**Understanding Conversations with Smart Speakers in Single-Person Households [N3]**, Lead Researcher 2021

**Investigating Information Needs for Awareness between Remote Workers [P1]**, Lead Researcher 2020

**Investigating Auditory Cues for Separateness of AI Speaker Services [N1]**, Lead Researcher 2019

## Publications

### PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

[R5] **Soobin Cho**, Deveshi Modi, Divya Mavinkurve, Jieqiong Ding, and Mark Zachry. 2027. Assessing the applicability of existing design recommendations to AI companion design: A multi-method study. ***International Journal of Human-Computer Studies*** 218 (2027), 103940. doi:10.1016/j.ijhcs.2026.103940 (arXiv:2609.14236)

[R4] Moyan Zhou, **Soobin Cho**, and Loren Terveen. 2026. LLMs in Wikipedia: Investigating How LLMs Impact Participation in Knowledge Communities. *Proc. ACM Hum.-Comput. Interact.* 10, 6, Article **CSCW**116 (October 2026), 20 pages. https://doi.org/10.1145/3816964

[R3] **Soobin Cho**, Mark Zachry, and David W. McDonald. 2025. Towards Insider Summarization for Mediation Instead of Moderation: Examining Wikipedian Views on Key Elements of Discussion Summaries. *Proc. ACM Hum.-Comput. Interact.* 9, 7, Article **CSCW**500 (November 2025), 25 pages. https://doi.org/10.1145/3757681

[R2] JaeWon Kim, **Soobin Cho**, Robert Wolfe, Jishnu Hari Nair, and Alexis Hiniker. 2025. Privacy as Social Norm: Systematically Empowering Teen Privacy Management on Social Media. *Proc. ACM Hum.-Comput. Interact.* 9, 2, Article **CSCW**151 (April 2025), 39 pages. https://doi.org/10.1145/3711049

[R1] **Soobin Cho**, Joongseek Lee, and Bongwon Suh. 2023. "I Want to Reveal, but I Also Want to Hide" Understanding the Conflict of Revealing and Hiding Needs in Virtual Study Rooms. *Proc. ACM Hum.-Comput. Interact*, 7, **CSCW**2, Article 300 (October 2023), 27 pages. https://doi.org/10.1145/3610091

### PEER-REVIEWED POSTERS AND EXTENDED ABSTRACTS

[P5] Jared Ren and **Soobin Cho**. 2026. "ChatGPT, Review This Message to My Prof" Investigating Students' Use of AI for Online Communication in Academic Settings. In *Companion of the Computer-Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing (**CSCW** Companion '26), October 10–14, 2026, Salt Lake City, UT, USA.* ACM, New York, NY, USA, 4 pages. https://doi.org/10.1145/3785651.3831512

[P4] **Soobin Cho**, Anna Lindner, Joseph S. Schafer, Pitch Sinlapanuntakul, Julie A. Vera, and Mark Zachry. 2025. Collaborative Autoethnography as a Method to Explore Short-Lived Social AI Chatbots. In *13th International Conference on Human-Agent Interaction (**HAI** '25), November 10–13, 2025, Yokohama, Japan.* ACM, New York, NY, USA, 3 pages. https://doi.org/10.1145/3765766.3765830

[P3] **Soobin Cho**, Bongwon Suh, and Joongseek Lee. 2022. "Hide Your Video, Show Your Action!" Investigating a New Video Conferencing Interface for Virtual Studying. In *Companion Computer Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing (**CSCW**'22 Companion), November 08–22, 2022, Virtual Event, Taiwan.* ACM, New York, NY, USA, 5 pages. https://doi.org/10.1145/3500868.3559451

[P2] Sang Ah Park, Yoon Young Lee, **Soobin Cho**, Minjoon Kim, and Joongseek Lee. 2021. "Knock Knock, Here Is an Answer from Next Door": Designing a Knowledge Sharing Chatbot to Connect Residents: Community Chatbot Design Case Study. In *Companion Publication of the 2021 Conference on Computer Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing (**CSCW** '21 Companion), October 23–27, 2021, Virtual Event, USA.* ACM, New York, NY, USA, 5 pages. https://doi.org/10.1145/3462204.3481738

[P1] **Soobin Cho**, Bongwon Suh, and Joongseek Lee. 2020. Not Too Much, Nor Too Less: Investigating Which Information Should Be Shared for Awareness Between Remote Workers. In *Companion Publication of the 2020 Conference on Computer Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing (**CSCW** '20 Companion)*. Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 239–243. https://doi.org/10.1145/3406865.3418308

NON-PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

[N6] **Soobin Cho**, Mark Zachry, and David W. McDonald. 2026. How Much Can AI Understand? Toward AI-Assisted Sensemaking of Collaborative Discussion in Groups with Shared History. arXiv:2608.27799 [cs.HC] (accepted at 2026 **CSCW workshop** *'Broader Impacts of GenAI in Communication'*)

[N5] Jared Ren and **Soobin Cho**. 2026. Delegating Before Learning: Where Generative AI Sits in Students' Professional Communication. arXiv:2608.28837 [cs.HC] (accepted at 2026 **CSCW workshop** *'Broader Impacts of GenAI in Communication'*)

[N4] **Soobin Cho**, Mark Zachry, and David W. McDonald. 2025. A Framework for AI-Supported Mediation in Community-based Online Collaboration. arXiv:2509.10015 [cs.HC] (accepted at 2025 **CSCW workshop** *'Augmenting Collaborative Problem-Solving: Exploring the Design and Use of GenAI for Groupwork'*)

[N3] **Soobin Cho**, Yoon Young Lee, Sang Ah Park, and Joongseek Lee. 2021. "Can Smart Speaker Be the 'SimSimi' for Single Households?": Study on the Use of Smart Speakers by Single Households. In *Proceedings of **HCI Korea** 2021.* The HCI Society of Korea, 6 pages. [dbpia]

[N2] Sang Ah Park, **Soobin Cho**, Yoon Young Lee, and Joongseek Lee. 2021. 'Naver Knowledge-iN' in a Speaker: Designing a Voice-Based Knowledge Sharing Service. In *Proceedings of **HCI Korea** 2021.* The HCI Society of Korea, 6 pages. [dbpia]

[N1] **Soobin Cho** and Joongseek Lee. 2020. Study on Auditory Cues for Conversation Separateness in AI Speaker Multi-Turn Services. In *Proceedings of **HCI Korea** 2020.* The HCI Society of Korea, 4 pages. [dbpia]

## Teaching Experience

DIRECTED RESEARCH GROUPS, University of Washington

**Understanding Online Community Norms to Build an AI Agent (2)** — Winter 2026
Directed 8 students to create training datasets for norm-aware AI agents as an extension of the research group project.

**Understanding Online Community Norms to Build an AI Agent (1)** — Fall 2025
Directed 6 students in understanding and labeling Wikipedia policy application cases to create training datasets for norm-aware AI agents.

**Design Principles for AI Companions (2)** — Winter 2025
Directed 3 students in conducting thematic analysis of over 400 design recommendations and performing internal and external heuristic evaluations to develop design principles.

**Design Principles for AI Companions (1)** — Fall 2024
Directed 11 students in experiencing diverse AI companions, conducting user research, and applying over 500 design recommendations from related fields through guided discussions.

TEACHING ASSISTANT

| | |
|---|---|
| **HCDE 518: User-Centered Design**, University of Washington | Fall 2026 |
| **HCID 510: Designing Interactive Systems**, University of Washington | Spring 2026 |
| **HCDE 501: Theoretical Foundations of HCDE**, University of Washington | Fall 2025, Winter 2026 |
| **HCDE 593: Master's Capstone**, University of Washington | Spring 2025 |
| **HCDE 592: Master's Capstone Planning**, University of Washington | Winter 2025 |
| **HCDE 519: Qualitative Research Methods**, University of Washington | Fall 2024 |
| **HCDE 300: Foundations of HCDE**, University of Washington | Spring 2024 |
| **Information Technology Practice**, Seoul National University | Spring 2020, Fall 2020 |

## Work Experience

**Soft Berry Inc.** Seoul, South Korea
*UX Researcher, Product Team* Mar 2022 - Aug 2023
*Korean Series A startup ($8M+ funding), operates Korea's leading EV charging station app*
- First and sole UX researcher, led end-to-end research strategy and execution.
- Ran mixed-methods studies: interviews, contextual inquiries, surveys, workshops, usage log analysis, and market/competitive research.
- Partnered with leadership (CEO, COO, PM Lead) to align goals and convert insights into product principles and design guidelines.
- Collaborated with designers and engineers to implement findings in the app.
- Shared research outcomes across the organization through presentations and reports.

**Weber Shandwick** Seoul, South Korea
*Junior Associate, Consumer Marketing Team* Sep 2017 - Oct 2018
- Clients: Netflix, Burger King, American Airlines, Ocean Spray
- Planned and executed digital and print PR campaigns, conducted performance analyses, and supported crisis management.

## Honors and Awards

**Graduate Student Conference Presentation Award**, University of Washington — Fall 2025
**Publication Achievement Award**, Seoul National University — Fall 2021
**Brain Korea 21 Four Scholarship**, Ministry of Education, Korea — Fall 2020, Spring 2021
**Brain Korea 21 Plus Scholarship**, Ministry of Education, Korea — Fall 2019, Spring 2020
**Honors Scholarship**, Ewha Womans University — Fall 2013, Fall 2014, Fall 2015, Spring 2017
**Dean's List**, Ewha Womans University — Spring 2013, Spring 2014, Fall 2014, Fall 2016, Spring 2017

## Invited Talks and Lectures

**HCID 590 (Design, Use, Build Seminar):** Guest Lecture — Oct 2025
**HCDE 545 (Qualitative Research Methods):** Guest Session on Qualitative Analysis — May 2025
**HCI Korea 2020 (Tutorial Session):** *Making 'Cool' Voice Service* — Aug 2020

## Review Service

**ACM CSCW** — 2023 - 2026
**ACM CHI** — 2025 - 2026
Special Recognition for Outstanding Reviews (CHI 2026, 2 papers)
**ACM CHI Late-Breaking Work** — 2022 - 2026
Special Recognition for Outstanding Reviews (CHI 2025 LBW)
**ACM CUI Short Papers** — 2025 - 2026
**Wiki Workshop** — 2026